Cisplatin + Etoposide

These two chemotherapy medicines aim to control the cancer. Your team will explain the expected benefit for you.

> **Check your treatment:** This summary is for chemotherapy for extensive-stage small-cell lung cancer. Treatment that also includes immunotherapy or radiotherapy needs its own complete plan.

Your treatment plan

Cisplatin is given on Day 1. Etoposide is given on Days 1–3. A cycle lasts 21 days (3 weeks); the team checks you before the next cycle.

1. **Before starting**

Blood tests and a review of your health. Confirm your three treatment days and whether etoposide is by drip or capsules.

2. **Treatment and time at home**

Both medicines on Day 1; etoposide continues on Days 2–3. Extra IV fluids help protect your kidneys. Follow your medicines plan at home.

3. **Review and next steps**

Usually 4–6 cycles. Your team may delay, reduce or stop treatment after reviewing your health and response.

Before and between visits

- Confirm whether Days 2–3 etoposide will be drips or prescribed capsules.
- Ask for a written anti-sickness plan covering every treatment day and the following days.
- Bring your medicines list and report hearing problems, numbness or signs of infection.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately for temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions.

Cannot reach the team? Seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Your contact plan

Ask your team to complete these before you leave.

Hospital / team _____

Daytime number and hours _____

Evening / weekend number _____

If unavailable, where to go _____

Keep this with your consent information. Ask your team about anything unclear.

What to watch for

Use the picture and symptom descriptions together. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1. Ears / hearing

Cisplatin

Report tinnitus or hearing change promptly; discuss existing problems before starting.

3. Chest / breathing

Both medicines

New breathlessness, wheeze or chest pain needs urgent assessment.

5. Stomach / bowel

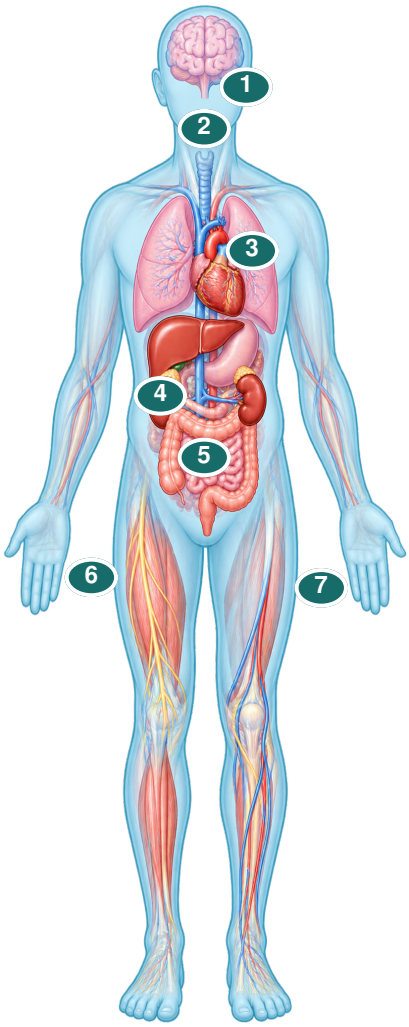
Both medicines

Use prescribed anti-sickness medicines; severe vomiting or diarrhoea needs advice.

7. Skin / blood counts

Both medicines

Report rash, unusual bruising or bleeding. Fever or sudden illness needs urgent advice.



2. Mouth

Etoposide

Mouth sores can affect eating or drinking. Seek advice early.

4. Kidneys / fluids

Cisplatin

Report reduced urine or inability to drink; kidney tests guide treatment.

6. Hands / feet

Cisplatin

Report numbness, tingling or problems with buttons, balance or walking.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Match each number to its symptom box. Blood, skin and nerve markers are schematic.

Call urgently for fever or shaking chills, sudden illness, new or worsening breathlessness, chest pain, uncontrolled bleeding, severe diarrhoea, vomiting despite medicines, inability to drink, very little urine, or a spreading/blistering rash. Tell staff immediately about wheeze, swelling, dizziness or faintness during an infusion. Report hearing changes, ringing in the ears, numbness, weakness or difficulty walking promptly.

My SACT card

Cisplatin + Etoposide

Day 1 platinum; etoposide Days 1–3. Repeat every 3 weeks.

I am receiving chemotherapy. Infection can be serious even without a fever. Contact my oncology team promptly if I become unwell.

Name: _____
Hospital: _____
Oncology phone: _____
Out of hours: _____

Show this card when seeking care. It does not replace a medicine-specific alert card.

More information, when you want it

Scan for medicines, tests, daily life and your treatment record.

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00280/